

Day 101 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in TN History/Culture/Heritage (8): Tamil Nadu State Film Awards (2016-2022)

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Tamil Nadu State Film Awards for 2016-2022, announced and held in early 2026 — a long-delayed batch covering 7 years' worth of Tamil cinema.

Q: When were the Tamil Nadu State Film Awards (2016-2022) winners announced, and when/where was the ceremony held?

A: Winners announced 30 January 2026; ceremony held 13 February 2026 at Kalaivanar Arangam, Chennai.

Q: Who presented the awards at the ceremony?

A: Deputy Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin.

Q: Which film won the Best Film (First Prize) for 2016?

A: 'Managaram' — with 'Puriyatha Puthir' and 'Maaveran Kittu' as the 2nd and 3rd prize winners respectively.

Q: What does each Tamil Nadu State Film Award consist of, and what is the cash prize for Best Film (1st/2nd/3rd)?

A: Each award includes a one-sovereign gold medal, a memento, and a certificate. Best Film cash prizes: ₹2 lakh (1st), ₹1 lakh (2nd), ₹75,000 (3rd).

Q: Which major Tamil film stars were among the winners across this 2016-2022 awards batch?

A: Suriya, Dhanush, Vikram, Vijay Sethupathi, Arya, Karthi, Nayanthara, Sai Pallavi, Keerthi Suresh, Jyothika, and director Lokesh Kanagaraj, among others.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Tamil Nadu State Film Awards (2016-2022) ceremony was held at:

A. Music Academy, Chennai

B. Kalaivanar Arangam, Chennai ✓

C. Raj Bhavan, Chennai

D. Anna University, Chennai

Explanation: Kalaivanar Arangam, Chennai. [medium, web-research]

2. The Tamil Nadu State Film Awards (2016-2022) winners were announced on:

A. 1 January 2026

B. 30 January 2026 ✓

C. 13 February 2026

D. 1 March 2026

Explanation: 30 January 2026 (ceremony followed on 13 February). [hard, web-research]

3. Who presented the Tamil Nadu State Film Awards (2016-2022) at the ceremony?

A. Chief Minister M.K. Stalin

B. Deputy Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin ✓

C. Governor of Tamil Nadu

D. The Union Culture Minister

Explanation: Deputy Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin. [medium, web-research]

4. Which film won the Best Film (First Prize) for 2016 in this awards batch?

A. Managaram ✓

B. Puriyatha Puthir

C. Maaveran Kittu

D. Visaranai

Explanation: Managaram. [hard, web-research]

5. The cash prize for the Best Film First Prize in the Tamil Nadu State Film Awards is:

- A. ₹1 lakh
- B. ₹1.5 lakh
- C. ₹2 lakh ✓**
- D. ₹5 lakh

Explanation: ₹2 lakh. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Ratio and Proportion

READING MATERIAL

Ratio & Proportion is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills, and real exam evidence shows it's tested through several distinct shapes, not just 'simplify this ratio'. Learn each shape as its own method.

Q: Real exam (2025): A man spends Rs.500 buying 12 tables and chairs. One table costs Rs.50, one chair costs Rs.40. Find the ratio of chairs to tables purchased.

A: Let tables= t , chairs= c . $t+c=12$ and $50t+40c=500$ (i.e. $5t+4c=50$). Substitute $t=12-c$: $5(12-c)+4c=50 \rightarrow 60-5c+4c=50 \rightarrow c=10$, so $t=2$. Ratio chairs:tables = $10:2 = 5:1$.

Q: Method — combining two ratios that share a common term: If $a:b=3:5$ and $b:c=7:8$, find $a:c$.

A: To chain two ratios, scale each so the SHARED term (b) matches in both. Here b is 5 in the first ratio and 7 in the second — $\text{LCM}(5,7)=35$. Scale $a:b=3:5$ by $\times 7 \rightarrow a:b=21:35$. Scale $b:c=7:8$ by $\times 5 \rightarrow b:c=35:40$. Now $a:b:c = 21:35:40$, so $a:c = 21:40$.

Q: Method — continued proportion (three terms in one ratio): If $a/10 = b/15 = c/20$, find $a:b:c$.

A: All three fractions equal the same constant, so $a:b:c$ is simply $10:15:20$, which reduces to $2:3:4$ (dividing by the HCF, 5).

Q: Method — chaining two ratios via a shared term: If $A:B=3:4$ and $B:C=8:9$, find $A:C$.

A: B is 4 in the first ratio and 8 in the second — scale the first ratio so B matches: multiply $A:B=3:4$ by 2 to get $A:B=6:8$. Now both ratios share $B=8$: $A:B:C = 6:8:9$. So $A:C = 6:9 = 2:3$.

Q: Method — mixture/alloy adjustment (add a pure ingredient to shift a ratio): A mixture of 60 L has acid:water = $2:1$. How much water must be added to make the ratio $1:2$?

A: Acid:water = $2:1$ in 60L means acid=40L, water=20L. We're only adding water (acid stays at 40L). We want acid:water = $1:2$, i.e. water = $2 \times \text{acid} = 80\text{L}$. Water to add = $80-20 = 60\text{L}$.

Q: Method — simplest form of an age ratio: Azhagan is 50 years old, his son is 10. What is the simplest ratio of their ages?

A: $50:10$ reduces (divide both by 10) to $5:1$.

Q: Method — finding an unknown in a proportion (cross-multiplication): If the numbers 2, 5, x , 20 (in that order) are in proportion, find x .

A: In proportion, $2:5 = x:20$, so $2 \times 20 = 5 \times x \rightarrow 40 = 5x \rightarrow x = 8$. (General rule: in $a:b=c:d$, $a \times d = b \times c$.)

Q: Method — the '4th proportional': Find the 4th proportional to 4, 16, and 7.

A: The 4th proportional x satisfies $4:16 = 7:x \rightarrow 4x = 16 \times 7 = 112 \rightarrow x = 28$.

Q: Method — splitting a total using a 3-part ratio and a given average: Three numbers are in ratio $3:5:7$ and their average is 60. Find the smallest number.

A: Average of 60 over 3 numbers means their total = 180. Split 180 in ratio $3:5:7$ (15 parts total): each part = $180/15 = 12$. Smallest = $3 \times 12 = 36$.

Q: Method — 'duplicate ratio' (squaring a ratio): What is the duplicate ratio of $2:7$?

A: The duplicate ratio of $a:b$ is $a^2:b^2$. So the duplicate ratio of $2:7$ is $4:49$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A woman spends Rs.620 buying 14 pens and notebooks. One pen costs Rs.30, one notebook costs Rs.50. Find the ratio of notebooks to pens purchased.

- A. 2:5
- B. 5:2 ✓**
- C. 3:4
- D. 4:3

Explanation: $p+n=14$; $30p+50n=620 \rightarrow 3p+5n=62$. Substitute $p=14-n$: $3(14-n)+5n=62 \rightarrow 42+2n=62 \rightarrow n=10$, $p=4$. Ratio notebooks:pens = $10:4 = 5:2$. [hard, authored]

2. If $x/8 = y/12 = z/20$, find $x:y:z$ in lowest terms.

- A. 2:3:5 ✓**
- B. 8:12:20
- C. 4:6:10
- D. 1:2:3

Explanation: $x:y:z = 8:12:20$, which reduces (divide by HCF=4) to $2:3:5$. [easy, authored]

3. If $P:Q = 2:3$ and $Q:R = 9:10$, find $P:R$.

A. 3:5 ✓

B. 2:5

C. 3:10

D. 9:20

Explanation: Scale $P:Q=2:3$ by 3 to get $P:Q=6:9$, matching $Q=9$ from $Q:R=9:10$. So $P:Q:R=6:9:10$, giving $P:R=6:10=3:5$. [medium, authored]

4. A 40 L mixture has milk:water = 3:1. How much water must be added to change the ratio to 3:2?

A. 5 L

B. 10 L ✓

C. 8 L

D. 6 L

Explanation: Milk:water=3:1 in 40L means milk=30L, water=10L. Milk stays fixed; we want water= $(2/3) \times \text{milk} = (2/3) \times 30 = 20$ L. Water to add = $20 - 10 = 10$ L. [hard, authored]

5. If 5, 8, x, 24 are in proportion, find x.

A. 12.5

B. 15 ✓

C. 16

D. 20

Explanation: $5:8 = x:24 \rightarrow 5 \times 24 = 8x \rightarrow 120 = 8x \rightarrow x = 15$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the 4th proportional to 3, 12, and 9.

A. 27

B. 36 ✓

C. 30

D. 33

Explanation: $3:12 = 9:x \rightarrow 3x = 12 \times 9 = 108 \rightarrow x = 36$. [easy, authored]

7. Three numbers are in the ratio 2:3:4 and their average is 45. Find the largest number.

A. 40

B. 50

C. 60 ✓

D. 45

Explanation: Average 45 over 3 numbers means total=135. 9 parts total, each part=15. Largest = $4 \times 15 = 60$. [medium, authored]

8. What is the duplicate ratio of 3:5?

A. 6:10

B. 9:25 ✓

C. 9:10

D. 3:25

Explanation: Duplicate ratio = square each term: $3^2:5^2 = 9:25$. [easy, authored]

9. A sum of Rs.450 is divided among 100 boys and girls, each boy getting Rs.5.10 and each girl Rs.3.60. Find the number of girls.

A. 20

B. 30

C. 40 ✓

D. 50

Explanation: Let girls=g, boys=100-g. $3.6g + 5.1(100-g) = 450 \rightarrow 3.6g + 510 - 5.1g = 450 \rightarrow -1.5g = -60 \rightarrow g = 40$. [hard, authored]

10. A father's age (40) to his daughter's age (8) — what is the simplest ratio?

A. 5:1 ✓

B. 8:1

C. 4:1

D. 10:1

Explanation: 40:8 reduces ($\div 8$) to 5:1. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The River" (Advice from a River) — Ilan Shamir

READING MATERIAL

Ilan Shamir's companion piece to "Advice from a Tree" — using a river's natural behavior as an extended metaphor for life advice. Like its companion poem, expect phrase-MEANING questions rather than figure-of-speech labelling.

Q: Who wrote "The River" (also known as "Advice from a River"), and how does it relate to another poem in this syllabus?

A: Ilan Shamir — the same poet who wrote "Advice from a Tree" (also in this syllabus). Both poems use a natural element (tree, river) as an extended metaphor for life wisdom.

Q: What does "Go with the flow" mean in the poem?

A: Accept circumstances as they come rather than resisting them — adapt gracefully to life's natural direction, instead of forcing control.

Q: What does "Be thoughtful of those downstream" mean?

A: Consider how your actions affect others who come after you or are affected by you later — a call for consideration and responsibility toward others.

Q: What does "Follow the path of least resistance" mean, and how does it lead to 'rapid success'?

A: Don't force difficult, conflict-heavy approaches — find the natural, easier way forward, similar to how a river finds the easiest route downhill rather than fighting obstacles head-on.

Q: What does "It takes time to carve the beauty of the canyon" mean?

A: Meaningful, beautiful achievements require patience and gradual effort — just as a river slowly carves a canyon over a long time, not instantly.

Q: What does "Go around the obstacles" mean, and what is the poem's concluding message?

A: Find ways around difficulties rather than confronting them head-on (adapt rather than force). The poem concludes: "The beauty is in the journey" — emphasizing that the process/experience of living matters more than reaching a final destination.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The River" ("Advice from a River") was written by:

- A. Henry Van Dyke
- B. Ilan Shamir ✓**
- C. Robert Frost
- D. William Wordsworth

Explanation: Ilan Shamir. [easy, authored]

2. "Go with the flow" means:

- A. Swim in a river
- B. Accept circumstances rather than resisting them ✓**
- C. Move quickly
- D. Follow a crowd blindly

Explanation: Accept circumstances rather than resisting them. [easy, authored]

3. "Be thoughtful of those downstream" means:

- A. Be careful near water
- B. Consider how your actions affect others ✓**
- C. Travel south
- D. Avoid rivers

Explanation: Consider how your actions affect others. [medium, authored]

4. "It takes time to carve the beauty of the canyon" means:

- A. Canyons are man-made
- B. Meaningful achievements require patience and gradual effort ✓**
- C. Rivers are dangerous
- D. Beauty doesn't last

Explanation: Meaningful achievements require patience and gradual effort. [medium, authored]

5. What is the poem's concluding message?

A. The destination matters more than the journey

B. The beauty is in the journey ✓

C. Rivers always flow to the sea

D. Obstacles should always be confronted directly

Explanation: The beauty is in the journey. [medium, authored]

6. "The River" and "Advice from a Tree" (both in this syllabus) share which feature?

A. Same poet (Ilan Shamir) ✓

B. Same rhyme scheme

C. Same number of stanzas

D. Both were written in the same year as a single combined poem

Explanation: Same poet, Ilan Shamir. [medium, authored]